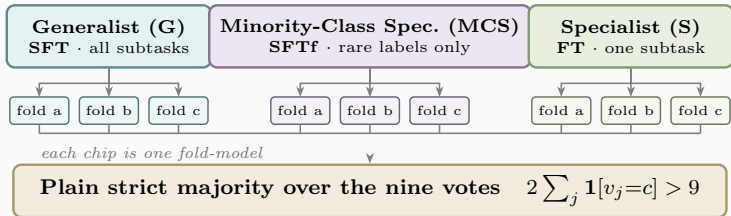


per-subtask voter ensemble — three branches, nine voters



*Fold coverage.* The three fold sets are chosen so that all five folds appear across the nine voters — no slice of the training data goes unused.

*Why the MCS cannot do harm.* It holds three of nine votes and never predicts the majority labels. While G and S agree on a majority label they already hold six votes and win; the MCS can only move the decision once the other two split — the uncertain cases where a sharper view of the rare classes helps. The gate is emergent and needs no threshold.